

The Hong Kong Polytechnic University

Subject Description Form

Subject Code	AF3319
Subject Title	Entrepreneurial Finance
Credit Value	3
Level	3
Pre-requisite/ Co-requisite/ Exclusion	None
Objectives	This subject enables students to build entrepreneurial spirits in a growth mindset and skillset, provide a systematic knowledge framework, development, and tools for future entrepreneurs, and understand the important business financing considerations.
Intended Learning Outcomes	Upon completion of the subject, students will be able to: - Understand and apply the entrepreneurial mindset to solve problems that can create value (value creation). - Assess the market potentials using proper frameworks (value potential). - Learn and differentiate various business models and apply customer factory models to accelerate customer acquisition (value capture). - Know the trade-off for startup financing (value delivery). - Prepare and present business presentations using recent initial public offering (IPO) cases or students' proposed startups.
Subject Synopsis/ Indicative Syllabus	Introduction Discuss the readiness for the state of mind of an entrepreneur and building an execution-oriented company culture. Essential Business Elements Discuss how to perform proper market research on business opportunities, evaluate the dynamics among various market players and channels, and assess the potential market opportunities. Design a go-to-market strategy that builds a sustainable business with proper metrics, such as customer lifetime value, acquisition cost, and customer service cost. Learn how to apply popular business models to a business and understand their advantages and challenges. Financing Understand the concept of startup financing and its implication for business growth and equity dilution.

Teaching/Learning Methodology	This subject will combine lectures with an interactive teaching approach. Students should be prepared for class and group discussions, group presentations, and business case studies. Through these interactive activities, students are expected to be able to develop an entrepreneurial mindset with a financial perspective.							
Assessment Methods in Alignment with Intended Learning Outcomes	Specific assessment methods/tasks	% weightin g	Intended subject learning outcomes to be assessed (Please tick as appropriate)					
			a	b	c	d	e	
	Continuous Assessment	100%						
	1. Class Participation	30%	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	
	2. Individual Assignment	20%	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	
	3. Final Project	50%	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	
	Total	100 %						
	Explanation of the appropriateness of the assessment methods in assessing the intended learning outcomes: Class participation: Attendance, discussions, quizzes, and presentations; Individual Assignment: An essay on a selected topic of ventures; Final project: Development and presentation of business plans.							

Student Study Effort Expected	Class contact:	
	▪ Lectures / Class participation / in-class presentation	39 Hrs.
	Other student study efforts:	
	▪ Real-life business case presentation	31 Hrs.
	▪ Business Plan Preparation and Presentation	30 Hrs.
	▪ On average, students are expected to spend 2 hours reading before class	20 Hrs.
	Total student study effort	120Hrs.
Reading List and References	• Leach, Chris J., Melicher, Ronald W., Entrepreneurial Finance, 2020. • The Lean Startup: How Today's Entrepreneurs Use Continuous Innovation to Create Radically Successful Businesses by Eric Ries, latest edition. • The Hard Thing About Hard Things: Building a Business When There Are No Easy Answers by Ben Horowitz, latest edition. • No Rules Rules: Netflix and the Culture of Reinvention by Reed Hastings and Erin Meyer, latest edition. • Zero to One: Notes on Startups, or How to Build the Future by Peter Thiel and Blake Masters, latest edition. • Traction: Get a Grip on Your Business by Gino Wickman, latest edition. • The Innovator's Dilemma: When New Technologies Cause Great Firms to Fail (Management of Innovation and Change) by Clayton M. Christensen, latest edition.	